Interactive tutorial

A demonstration played from a recorded game, with text at each step. The player takes over three times: an upgrade exercise, a paid purchase, and the end of a game. Each scene lists what's on screen, the text, and what the player does. Your wording is kept wherever it worked; the changes are listed after the flow.

The flow

1. Welcome

Shows: a title card, nothing else.

> Century is about using the cards on the board to build an efficient engine that makes the crystals you need to claim golems. A more detailed explanation of the game and its rules is here.

Player: clicks Next.

2. The caravan

Shows: the caravan pops up below the text, holding an assortment of crystals.

> Crystals are Century's currency. Your caravan, shown below, is where you keep them. Note that it only has 10 spaces.

3. Crystal order

Shows: the Double Upgrade card appears in the middle of the right side.

> Crystals come in 4 colours: Yellow, Green, Blue and Magenta, in that order. What do we mean by "order"? That brings us to our first card: the Double Upgrade.
>
> The Double Upgrade is one of the two cards every player starts with. It upgrades your crystals by two levels in total. See below.

4. Try it: upgrade

Shows: the Double Upgrade moves to the top of the page, with the caravan to the right, below it. The caravan resets to 3 yellow, 1 green and 1 blue before each objective.

> Click the Double Upgrade, then complete each objective:
>
> 1. Turn 2 yellows into 2 greens.
> 2. Turn 1 green into blue, and 1 blue into magenta.
> 3. Turn 1 yellow into blue.

Player: clicks crystals, then Confirm, once per objective. Confirm only works once both steps are used.

> So a Double Upgrade can lift two crystals one level each, or one crystal two levels. Magenta is the top level, so it can't go any higher. The Triple Upgrade works the same way, with three steps.

5. One thing per turn

> On your turn you do exactly one thing: pick up a merchant card, play a card, reset, or claim a golem. With that, let's take a look at the game.

6. Merchant cards

Shows: the recorded game's board, with a rectangle around the merchant row.

> These are merchant cards: the cards available to pick up. The leftmost card is free, and once you take it, your turn is over.

Shows: a circle around the third card.

> Suppose you want the third card. To take it, you place one crystal on each card you skip, as payment. Any crystals already sitting on the card you take are yours, and the ones you leave behind go to whoever takes those cards later.

Player: drags one crystal onto each of the first two cards, then clicks the third. This is the recording's next move, so the replay carries on from it.

7. Your play space

Shows: your mat highlighted: caravan on the left, then Playable and Played.

> Now that you've acquired the card, take a look at your play space. On the left is your caravan. In the middle are the cards you've acquired. Playable are the cards you can play; every player starts with a +2Y and a Double Upgrade.

8. Three types of cards

Shows: three example cards, evenly spaced across the middle of the screen, with text to the right of each.

> - **Crystal cards** add the crystals shown on the card to your caravan. There are only a handful of these in the deck.
> - **Conversion cards** make up most of the deck. You hand over the crystals the card asks for and receive the ones it gives. What makes them special is that you can repeat them as many times as you like in the same turn, as long as you have the crystals, so you get more bang for your buck. Careful: repeating a big conversion can overfill your caravan, and anything over 10 is discarded, cheapest first.
> - **Upgrade cards,** as covered above (Double and Triple Upgrade).

9. Played cards and Reset

Shows: the Played row highlighted, then the Reset button.

> Playing any card uses your turn and moves it to your Played section. Cards there can't be played. To get them back, click Reset, which returns every played card to Playable. This also uses a turn, so plan to reset as rarely as you can.
>
> The best approach is a good mix of cards that make crystals and cards that convert them. Build that engine early, then claim golems quickly.

10. Golems and scoring

Shows: a rectangle around the golem row.

> The game ends on the number of golems collected: 6 in a 2–3 player game, 5 with 4–5 players. Once someone reaches that, the current round is finished, then points are counted to find the winner.
>
> There are always 5 golems on the board. On your turn you can claim any of them if you have the crystals listed at the bottom of the card, next to its points. The two leftmost golems are special: they have coins above them, worth +3 and +1 to whoever claims them. There are only a limited number of coins, so keep an eye on them.
>
> At the end you score your golems' points, your coins, and 1 point for every crystal that isn't yellow. On a tie, the player later in turn order wins.

11. Your turn to finish

Shows: the recording fast-forwards to near the end, then hands you control.

> That covers most of the game. Let's skip ahead to near the end. You're in control now. Can you finish it?

Player: plays freely until the game ends, then sees the Final Tally with three buttons: Keep playing, Practice vs bots, and Read the rules.

What changed from your draft

Rule fixes

- **Golem target:** it's 6 golems with 2–3 players and 5 with 4–5. The draft said 6 for 2 players only.
- **Discards:** this app discards automatically, cheapest first. Players don't choose.
- **Upgrades:** they raise crystals, not cards. "Magnitudes" is now "levels", the rulebook's word.

Added, because players miss them otherwise

- **One action per turn** (scene 5).
- **Crystals on a card come with it**, and the ones you leave go to the next taker (scene 6).
- **Scoring and ties** (scene 10).
- **"Build early, claim fast"** (scene 9), from the solver study. Drop it if you'd rather not give strategy.

Wording

- **"Gems" is now "crystals"**, and "pink" is now "magenta", to match the app and the rules page.
- **"Conversion cards" is kept**, since the trade dialog says Conversions. The rules page calls them trade cards, so pick one name for both.
- **"Acquisition and conversion cards"** is now "cards that make crystals and cards that convert them". Check that's what you meant.
- **Typos:** "term" is now "turn", "bottom" is now "button", and "ratio it" is now "repeat it".

Build notes

The recording. Store a real game as a seed plus its list of moves, and replay it on the server through `apply_action`, so there's no second copy of the rules. A 2-player game keeps the layout simple and matches the "6 golems" in the text. It needs to have:

- a turn where the viewer's seat takes the 3rd merchant card, for scene 6;
- a late position where that seat is 2–3 turns from its 6th golem and the opponent can't win first, for scene 11.

Scenes 1–4 are staged screens, not the board. They reuse `CaravanGrid` and the card components with mock data. The upgrade exercise is still checked by the engine: the server runs a small sandbox game with the set caravan and the Double Upgrade in hand, then compares the result with the objective.

Scene 6 must match the recorded move exactly, payment colours included, because those crystals affect every later turn. The bubble names the colours to drag.

Scene 11 hands the seat to the player. The opponent carries on as an Easy bot, reusing `bot_policy.py`.

Carried over from the earlier plan:

- Bubbles and the red outline reuse `guide-target`.
- Next or Enter advances. Each bubble shows "Step N of M" and a Skip tutorial link.
- A refresh resumes at the same scene.
- `state.tutorial` is written into `CONTRACT.md` first, and ordinary rooms never carry it.
- **Entry:** How to play → rules page → Try the tutorial, via `?tutorial=true` with a 4-character room code, which keeps the photo art.

Tests

- Replay the whole recording through `apply_action`.
- Each upgrade objective accepts right answers and rejects wrong ones.
- Scene 6 rejects any other move.
- Ordinary rooms have no `tutorial` field.
- Playwright screenshots of every scene at desktop and phone widths.

Open questions

- **Help in scene 11?** A Hint button could highlight the recording's own next move, which needs no solver.
- **Theme in the copy?** Keep the game's words (crystals, golems), or lean into the hockey photos?
- **First-visit prompt?** Offer the tutorial automatically on someone's first visit, or only through How to play?